Winter option 3

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Peanut tofu bowls
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Lentil soup
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Zapiekanka
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Tofu stir fry
- **Breakfast:** Blueberry banana baked oatmeal **Snack:** Energy balls
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) for lunch and Kopytka (potato dumplings) for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 687 kcal, 53 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 511 kcal, 27 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2213 kcal**, 144 g **HER 1772 kcal**, 106 g
Wed	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 687 kcal, 53 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 511 kcal, 27 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**HIM 2232 kcal**, 161 g **HER 1780 kcal**, 100 g
Thu, Fri	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2154 kcal**, 140 g **HER 1739 kcal**, 96 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 707 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 536 kcal, 25 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2289 kcal**, 150 g **HER 1717 kcal**, 88 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 707 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 536 kcal, 25 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2289 kcal**, 150 g **HER 1717 kcal**, 88 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with lentil soup (about 55 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
2. Then blueberry banana baked oatmeal (about 45 min). Make 2 x the recipe (12 squares).
3. Then peanut tofu bowls (about 40 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
4. Then energy balls (10 min of work plus 30 min chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls).
5. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
6. Box everything. Lentil soup for Thursday and Friday goes in the freezer; Wednesday's dinner portion can stay in the fridge.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Lentil soup from the fridge for dinner. Move Thursday's lunch boxes from the freezer to the fridge.
Thursday	Cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow. Move Friday's lunch boxes to the fridge.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) (about 105 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) (about 40 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $200.06 for both of you for the seven days ($100.03 each). Buying every pack new costs about $329.96 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Winter option 3

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: chili paste (sambal oelek), cumin, coriander, paprika, bay leaves, cinnamon, baking powder, vanilla, ketchup, sesame seeds, thyme or rosemary, allspice, juniper berries, cloves, marjoram, 2 prunes, 10 dried wild mushrooms, 500 mL beet kvass, dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), garlic powder.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	7.5	8 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$6.83
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	283 g	2 x 142 g	$4.99	$9.94
☐ Banana	4	4 x each	$0.39	$1.56
☐ Beets, loose	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$2.64
☐ Broccoli	700 g	loose, by weight	$1.10/100 g	$7.70
☐ Carrots	310 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.09
☐ Celery	150 g	1 x bunch, about 675 g	$5.49	$1.22
☐ Celery root	245 g	1 x about 355 g	$3.12	$2.15
☐ Fresh ginger	25 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.17
☐ Garlic	0.8 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.34
☐ Green onions	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$2.49	$2.49
☐ Leek	1	1 x each	$2.12	$2.12
☐ Lemon	1	1 x each	$0.99	$0.99
☐ Red bell pepper	2	2 x each	$2.98	$5.96
☐ White mushrooms, loose	520 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$6.86
☐ Yellow onions	380 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$1.39
☐ Yellow potatoes	1 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$1.54
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ 2% milk (Dairyland)	500 mL	1 x 4 L	$6.35	$0.79
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	500 g	1 x 750 g	$8.25	$5.50
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	4.57 block	5 x 350 g	$3.99	$18.23
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	5.25 kg	3 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$36.87
☐ Large white eggs	12	1 x 18	$7.45	$4.97
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	240 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$3.40
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	62 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$0.91
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Green lentils, bulk bin	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.89/100 g	$3.56
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	345 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.73
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	572 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$2.52
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	16 slice	2 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$5.32
Pantry & cans				
☐ Diced tomatoes in juice (Western Family)	400 mL	1 x 796 mL can	$2.39	$1.20
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	75 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$1.20
☐ Ground flaxseed (Only Goodness)	21 g	1 x 453 g	$8.99	$0.42
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	382 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$5.64
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	128 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$3.21
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	325 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.95
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	75 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$1.49
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	40 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$0.86
☐ Rice vinegar (Marukan)	30 mL	1 x 355 mL	$5.79	$0.49
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	125 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$0.97
☐ Vegetable broth, low sodium (Western Family)	1.5 L	2 x 946 mL	$2.49	$3.95
☐ Walnut halves and pieces, bulk bin	60 g	loose, by weight	$2.69/100 g	$1.61
Frozen				
☐ Frozen blueberries (Western Family)	440 g	1 x 600 g	$6.99	$5.13
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	300 g	1 x 500 g	$2.99	$1.79
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$200.06**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$329.96**

Cook and split: Winter option 3

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Peanut tofu bowls SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: pinchofyum.com/spicy-peanut-tofu-bowls (Pinch of Yum)

BUY FOR IT	2.3 block extra firm tofu; 30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 700 g broccoli; 2 red bell pepper; 280 g long grain brown rice; 130 g natural smooth peanut butter; 80 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 30 mL pure sesame oil; 30 mL rice vinegar; 42 g liquid honey; 10 g fresh ginger; 0.1 bulb garlic. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Press and cube the tofu, toss with cornstarch, and roast it on a sheet pan with the broccoli and pepper strips. 2. Cook the rice. 3. Blend peanut butter, soy, sesame oil, vinegar, chili paste, sweetener, ginger, garlic and water into a sauce. 4. Bowl up rice, tofu and vegetables; drizzle with sauce.
SPLIT	Set 1 serving aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.95 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.71.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: edamame 100 g.
KEEP	The author says the leftovers suit meal prep and that it freezes. Fridge life of 4 days is my guidance.
REHEAT	Microwave 90 s; add the peanut sauce after.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), peanuts, sesame
HEAT	The heat is only the chili paste in the peanut sauce. Leave it out of the blender; he adds sambal to his own bowl.
NOTE	Costed with brown rice in place of white.

Blueberry banana baked oatmeal SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (12 squares) · about 45 min · full recipe: skinnytaste.com/baked-oatmeal-with-blueberries-and (Skinnytaste)

BUY FOR IT	4 banana; 440 g frozen blueberries; 170 g liquid honey; 180 g large flake oats; 60 g walnut halves and pieces, bulk bin; 500 mL 2% milk; 2 large white eggs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Layer banana slices and half the blueberries in a baking dish with honey and cinnamon; bake 15 min. 2. Mix oats, nuts, baking powder; whisk milk, egg, honey and vanilla. 3. Top the fruit with the oat mix and the liquid, add the rest of the berries, bake about 30 min.
SPLIT	Each weekday: 1.4 squares for him, 1 square for her. That uses all 12.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g, 1/2 x almonds 30 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g, apple.
KEEP	3 to 4 days in the fridge (author). Freeze Friday's squares (my guidance).
REHEAT	Microwave about 60 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Eggs, milk, tree nuts (walnuts); oats can carry gluten

Energy balls SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/energy-balls (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	165 g large flake oats; 21 g ground flaxseed; 195 g natural smooth peanut butter; 170 g liquid honey; 128 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Stir oats, flax, peanut butter, honey, vanilla and chocolate chips. 2. Chill 30 min, then roll into about 18 balls.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 2 balls for him, 1.5 balls for her. 2.5 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	2 weeks in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).
REHEAT	Eat cold.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy; oats can carry gluten

Zapiekanka MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT 1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.

SIDES Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.

KEEP The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.

REHEAT Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.

ALLERGENS Wheat, milk

NOTE Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.

Lentil soup SUNDAY

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 55 min · full recipe: recipetineats.com/lentil-soup (RecipeTin Eats)

BUY FOR IT 30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 150 g carrots; 150 g celery; 400 g green lentils, bulk bin; 400 mL diced tomatoes in juice; 1.5 L vegetable broth, low sodium; 1 lemon. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Soften onion and garlic, then carrot and celery, slowly. 2. Add lentils, tomato, broth and spices; simmer about 35 min. 3. Blitz a little of it to thicken, finish with lemon.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.

SIDES Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cheddar 30 g.

KEEP 5 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).

REHEAT Microwave 2 to 3 min with a splash of water.

ALLERGENS None of the major allergens (check the broth label)

NOTE Meatless (made with vegetable broth) and the cheapest pot in the plan.

Tofu stir fry THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT 2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.

SIDES Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.

KEEP Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).

REHEAT Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).

ALLERGENS Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame

HEAT Leave the chili paste out of the pan; he adds it at the table.

NOTE Meatless.

Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 105 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-red-borscht-vegan (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	400 g beets, loose; 160 g carrots; 245 g celery root; 220 g white mushrooms, loose; 1 leek; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 0.5 ambrosia apple; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Roast beets, carrots, root vegetables, mushrooms, leek, onion, garlic and herbs at 425 F until golden, 30 to 40 min. 2. Deglaze the pan, then simmer everything with water, bay, allspice, juniper, cloves, a prune or two and dried mushrooms. 3. Strain, then stir in the beet kvass and marjoram; season to taste.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	Up to 7 days in the fridge in a lidded container (author).
REHEAT	Reheat gently, 2 min in the microwave; do not boil it hard or the colour dulls.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (sulphites if you use the wine)
NOTE	Polish barszcz czerwony, the clear beet broth, not the chunky Ukrainian soup. It needs about 500 mL of beet kvass (zakwas), a few dried wild mushrooms and 2 prunes, none of which are costed: a Polish deli sells kvass, or the author links her own 5 day recipe. It is a light soup, so it is paired with bread and something more filling.

Kopytka (potato dumplings) SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.
SPLIT	Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.
SIDES	Him: 100 g diced chicken. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.
REHEAT	Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)
NOTE	You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.